



Subject Vision and Intent: History

Our Vision

At King's Cross Academy, we believe that understanding history is essential in helping children make sense of the world and their place within it. Our ambition is for children to leave KCA with a secure and connected understanding of the past, an appreciation of its complexity and the curiosity to continue asking questions about how people, places and societies have changed over time.

In our diverse community, history provides powerful opportunities for children to explore identity, encounter different perspectives and understand how the past has shaped the world in which they live. We want children to see themselves within the story of the past while also encountering people, cultures and experiences beyond their own.

Our History curriculum reflects our Academy vision, *Love Learning Together*, by encouraging children to be curious, to question what they encounter and to learn from the experiences and perspectives of others. Our KCA values are developed through the study of individuals and societies, helping children consider human choices, achievements, challenges and change across time.

Our Intent

Our History curriculum is ambitious, inclusive and carefully sequenced. It identifies the essential knowledge, vocabulary, concepts and historical thinking that we want children to develop from the Early Years to Year 6, enabling them to build increasingly rich and connected knowledge of the past.

Children study significant people, events, societies and periods from British and wider world history. Knowledge is deliberately built over time, with children revisiting and deepening their understanding of important historical concepts including chronology, continuity and change, cause and consequence, similarity and difference, and historical significance.

Alongside this substantive knowledge, children learn how historical knowledge is constructed. They are taught to ask increasingly sophisticated questions, examine and evaluate evidence, consider the usefulness and limitations of sources, compare accounts and recognise that interpretations of the past can differ. In doing so, children learn that

history is not simply a collection of facts, but a discipline through which we investigate and make sense of the past.

Vocabulary is explicitly taught and revisited so that children develop the language needed to talk, think and write about history with increasing precision. Opportunities for discussion, debate and historical enquiry enable pupils to explain their thinking, justify conclusions and listen critically to the interpretations of others.

Our location provides exceptional opportunities to make history meaningful. Children explore the history of King's Cross and London alongside national and global histories, using the people, places, buildings, museums and cultural institutions around them to connect classroom learning with the historical world beyond school.

Every Child

We have high expectations for every child. Children with SEND, children who are disadvantaged and children who are developing English as an additional language access the same ambitious History curriculum.

Teachers identify the essential knowledge and concepts that all children need to understand and adapt teaching so that barriers to learning are reduced without lowering expectations. Explicit vocabulary teaching, carefully selected sources, visual and practical resources, structured discussion, retrieval and opportunities to revisit important knowledge support children in developing secure historical understanding.

By the end of Year 6, our aim is for children not simply to know more about the past, but to understand how that knowledge connects. We want them to recognise chronology and change, consider causes and consequences, question evidence and appreciate that the past can be viewed from different perspectives. Above all, we want children to leave KCA as curious and thoughtful historians who understand that studying the past helps them better understand the world they inhabit.